

Eve-Stephanie Yamdjieu Kontcho | Information Systems Portfolio

Louisiana State University

Case Study: Agile Project Management & Scrum Facilitation (Caffeine Finder)

Professional Summary

This case study highlights my practical application of Agile methodologies and Scrum facilitation. As I prepare for the Certified ScrumMaster credential, this sprint deliverable demonstrates my ability to manage a cross-functional team, prioritize user needs, and monitor sprint health to deliver a user-centric product.

Project Overview & Objective

- **Product Vision:** The "Caffeine Finder" is an application designed to help university students rapidly locate caffeine sources, including cafes, coffee shops, campus dining, vending areas, and campus events.
- **The Objective:** Consolidating location, schedule, preference, and budget information into one application to streamline student decision-making.
- **My Role (Scrum Master):** Facilitated a cross-functional Agile team consisting of a Product Owner and five Developers to execute a 10-day sprint cycle.

Backlog Management & Requirements Gathering

- **Product Backlog:** Managed a comprehensive Product Backlog consisting of 29 distinct user stories mapping to diverse functional requirements, such as displaying location details, integrating turn-by-turn navigation, and applying real-time "Open Now" status filters.
- **Estimation & Prioritization:** Utilized Planning Poker with the team to assign story points and accurately estimate the developmental effort required for each feature.

- **Sprint Scoping:** Successfully defined and scoped a 10-day Sprint Backlog pulling in 10 prioritized backlog items, totaling 87 story points.

Sprint Execution & Metrics

- **Sprint Tracking:** Actively tracked the completion of 87 story points across the 10-day sprint timeline using a detailed Sprint Burndown Chart.
- **Velocity Monitoring:** Utilized the "Ideal Burndown" versus "Actual Burndown" trendlines to monitor team velocity, identify bottlenecks, and keep the sprint on schedule.

Agile Ceremonies & Continuous Improvement

- **Sprint Retrospective:** Led the retrospective ceremony to analyze team performance, championing a culture of continuous improvement.
- **Key Successes:** Fostered highly productive meetings, strong team alignment, successful Planning Poker discussions, and effective feature scoping.
- **Adaptation & Problem Solving:** Addressed challenges such as overlapping backlog features and the complexity of writing technical user stories. Implemented an actionable improvement plan to gain a stronger grasp of technical details beforehand to better refine and prioritize future backlog items.